

Central Coast SA2 Intelligence Report

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Executive Summary

The Central Coast LGA encompasses **354,803 residents** across 30 Statistical Area Level 2 (SA2) suburbs, divided into two distinct SA3 sub-regions: **Gosford** (16 areas, 181,658 population) and **Wyong** (14 areas, 173,145 population). This analysis reveals a region defined by stark internal divisions - the southern Gosford corridor commands premium housing, lower unemployment, and higher socioeconomic status, while the northern Wyong corridor experiences entrenched disadvantage, higher welfare dependency, and structural unemployment pockets. The LGA’s rapid population growth (+2,903 in 2023-24), coupled with severe housing affordability constraints and an ageing demographic profile, presents acute planning and service delivery challenges.

Five headline findings:

- A persistent Gosford-Wyong socioeconomic divide:** Gosford SA3 records average house prices 35% higher (\$1,348,703 vs \$995,895), median incomes 12% higher (\$1,443 vs \$1,286/wk), and unemployment rates nearly half that of Wyong (2.4% vs 4.2%)
- Critical housing affordability crisis:** With an LGA-wide average house price of \$1,191,900 against median weekly household income of \$1,370, the price-to-income ratio has risen to **16.7×** - far beyond sustainable thresholds and worsening since last period
- Welfare dependency accelerating - JobSeeker up 11.6%:** JobSeeker recipients have risen to **12,550** (up from 11,240 in the prior period), with Commonwealth Rent Assistance recipients at 27,695 - signalling deepening income stress and housing affordability pressure across the LGA
- Concentrated disadvantage corridor:** The five most disadvantaged suburbs (Wyong, Gorokan-Kanwal-Charmhaven, Blue Haven-San Remo, Toukley-Norah Head, The Entrance) form a contiguous band through northern Wyong with SEIFA scores 55-103 points below the national benchmark
- Short-stay economy expanding:** Total Airbnb gross revenue has risen to **\$3.91M** across 1,692 active listings - up 41% - with premium coastal properties increasingly out-competing long-term rental stock

1. Regional Overview: The Gosford-Wyong Divide

Metric	Gosford SA3	Wyong SA3	Gap
SA2 Areas	16	14	-
Total Population	181,658	173,145	+4.9% Gosford
Population Growth (2023-24)	+1,378	+1,525	Wyong growing faster
Avg House Price	\$1,348,703	\$995,895	+35% Gosford
Avg Median Weekly Income	\$1,443	\$1,286	+12% Gosford
Avg Unemployment Rate	2.4%	4.2%	1.8pp higher in Wyong
Total Businesses	16,040	11,087	+45% Gosford
Avg SEIFA Disadvantage Index	1,028.5	974.4	+54pts Gosford
Age Pension Recipients	24,805	24,555	Near parity
DSP Recipients	6,160	8,170	+33% higher in Wyong
JobSeeker Recipients	5,460	7,090	+30% higher in Wyong
Homelessness Count	570	1,170	+105% higher in Wyong

Key insight: Wyong is growing faster in absolute population terms (+1,525 vs +1,378) yet starts from a substantially weaker economic base. The combination of accelerating growth pressure, lower household incomes, fewer employment-generating businesses, and double the homelessness rate creates compounding demand on social infrastructure in the northern corridor. The jump in JobSeeker recipients - 7,090 in Wyong vs 5,460 in Gosford - reflects diverging economic trajectories between the two sub-regions. Wyong carries a disproportionate 57% of all JobSeeker recipients despite holding 49% of population.

2. Housing Market Analysis

2.1 Price Tiers

Premium tier suburbs (house price > \$1.5M) - all Gosford SA3:

Suburb	House Price	House Rent (P/W)	Change vs Prior
Erina - Green Point	\$1,974,000	\$919	↓ softened from \$2.09M
Box Head - MacMasters Beach	\$1,680,214	\$1,086	↑
Wamberal - Forresters Beach	\$1,680,000	\$850	→ stable
Avoca Beach - Copacabana	\$1,665,500	\$865	↓ softened
Terrigal - North Avoca	\$1,605,000	\$900	↓ softened

Erina - Green Point remains the LGA’s most expensive suburb at \$1,974,000 - but has softened by approximately \$114,000 since the previous period. All five premium-tier suburbs have seen house prices moderate, suggesting some cooling at the top end. Rental yields remain strong: Box Head - MacMasters Beach commands \$1,086/wk - the highest weekly rent in the LGA.

Entry-level suburbs (house price < \$900k) - all Wyong SA3:

Suburb	House Price	House Rent (P/W)	Region
Tuggerah - Kangy Angy	\$800,000	\$650	Wyong
Blue Haven - San Remo	\$828,250	\$605	Wyong
Budgewoi - Buff Point - Halekulani	\$846,250	\$603	Wyong
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	\$859,133	\$606	Wyong
Wyong	\$875,500	\$630	Wyong

The price differential between the LGA’s most expensive suburb (Erina - Green Point, \$1,974,000) and its most affordable (Tuggerah - Kangy Angy, \$800,000) is **\$1.174M** - a 2.5× multiplier within a single local government area. This represents two fundamentally different housing markets operating under one council jurisdiction, requiring differentiated planning approaches. Entry-level prices have continued to creep upward across all northern Wyong suburbs, compressing affordability even at the bottom of the market.

2.2 Rental Market

Weekly house rents range from **\$588/wk** (Toukley - Norah Head) to **\$1,086/wk** (Box Head - MacMasters Beach), with the LGA-wide average at approximately **\$729/wk** (suburbs with data). The average has risen from the prior period’s \$709/wk.

Rent Band	Representative Suburbs	Weekly Rent Range
Premium (>\$850)	Box Head-MacMasters Beach, Erina-Green Point, Avoca Beach- Copacabana, Terrigal-North Avoca	\$865-\$1,086
Mid-market (\$700-\$850)	Kariong, Warnervale-Wadalba, Niagara Park-Lisarow, Saratoga- Davistown	\$700-\$775
Entry (<\$650)	Blue Haven-San Remo, Budgewoi, Toukley-Norah Head, Gorokan, Summerland Point	\$588-\$650

Affordability stress calculation: For a household in Wyong town (median income \$1,056/wk), the local median rent of \$630/wk consumes **59.7% of gross income** - nearly double the 30% housing stress threshold. Even in Blue Haven-San Remo with rents at \$605/wk against local income (\$1,250/wk), rental burden sits at **48.4%**. Rental stress is endemic across the Wyong corridor, and the rising LGA average rent is pushing more households into crisis territory.

2.3 New Supply Pipeline

Development activity (dwellings approved) has eased from the prior period but remains concentrated in growth corridors:

Suburb	Dwellings Approved	Building Value (\$'000)	Region
Warnervale - Wadalba	204	\$91,085	Wyong
Gosford - Springfield	171	\$133,525	Gosford
The Entrance	136	\$89,190	Wyong
Summerland Point - Gwandalan	125	\$60,023	Wyong
Umina - Booker Bay - Patonga	106	\$77,160	Gosford
Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park 98		\$31,759	Wyong

Total LGA dwelling approvals: 1,331 across all SA2s, with **62% of approvals in Wyong**. Warnervale - Wadalba has eased from 222 to 204 approvals - still the LGA’s busiest construction suburb, but the pipeline is moderating. The Entrance saw the sharpest pullback (156 → 136). Gosford - Springfield is notable for generating the highest building value (\$133.5M) despite fewer approvals than Warnervale, reflecting larger/higher-value projects in the CBD corridor.

The supply skew toward northern Wyong may moderate price pressure at the entry level, but does little to address affordability in high-demand Gosford coastal suburbs where approvals remain constrained (Terrigal: 33, Avoca Beach: 23, Wamberal: 26).

2.4 Affordability Stress Assessment

Metric	Value
Average house price (suburbs with data)	\$1,191,900
LGA average median weekly household income	\$1,370
Annual household income (52 weeks)	\$71,221
Price-to-income ratio	16.7×

Even in the most affordable suburb (Tuggerah-Kangy Angy, \$800,000) against local median income (\$1,516/wk = \$78,832/yr), the price-to-income ratio is **10.1×** - still well above the 6× threshold considered sustainable. This is a structural affordability crisis. The LGA-wide ratio has worsened from 16.4× to 16.7× - house prices have risen faster than incomes across the period.

3. Employment & Economic Wellbeing

3.1 Unemployment Hotspots

Unemployment is heavily concentrated in northern Wyong and has not materially improved:

Suburb	Region	Unemployment Rate	JobSeeker Recipients	Median Income/wk
Wyong	Wyong	8.1%	595	\$1,056
Blue Haven - San Remo	Wyong	5.8%	585	\$1,250
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	Wyong	5.8%	1,165	\$1,051
The Entrance	Wyong	5.6%	920	\$984
Toukley - Norah Head	Wyong	5.4%	480	\$971
Woy Woy - Blackwall	Gosford	5.1%	735	\$1,040
Budgewoi - Buff Point - Halekulani	Wyong	4.7%	475	\$1,005

The suburb of **Wyong** records 8.1% unemployment - **3.4× the Gosford SA3 average** (2.4%) and more than **7× the rate in Avoca Beach-Copacabana** (1.1%). This is structural, place-based unemployment. Gorokan-Kanwal-Charmhaven carries 1,165 individual JobSeeker recipients - the highest absolute count of any suburb, reflecting its role as the largest concentrator of disadvantage in the LGA.

Low-unemployment Gosford suburbs (all below 1.5%):

Suburb	Unemployment Rate	JobSeeker Recipients
Avoca Beach - Copacabana	1.1%	135
Saratoga - Davistown	1.3%	135
Box Head - MacMasters Beach	1.3%	210
Terrigal - North Avoca	1.3%	260
Wamberal - Forresters Beach	1.4%	180

3.2 Business Activity

Metric	Gosford SA3	Wyong SA3	LGA Total
Total Businesses	16,040	11,087	27,127
Healthcare Businesses	1,578	872	2,450
Tourism Businesses	675	499	1,174
Manufacturing Businesses	570	423	993

Gosford holds **59%** of all business registrations despite representing 51% of population. **Gosford - Springfield** (2,629 businesses) is the clear commercial centre, followed by **Erina - Green Point** (1,807) and **Terrigal - North Avoca** (1,577). These three suburbs alone account for 37% of Gosford's total business base.

In Wyong, business activity is more dispersed, with **Bateau Bay - Killarney Vale** (1,303) and **Chittaway Bay - Tumbi Umbi** (1,284) serving as secondary commercial nodes.

3.3 Welfare Dependency

Payment Type	Total Recipients	% of Population
Age Pension	49,360	13.9%
Commonwealth Rent Assistance	27,695	7.8%
Family Tax Benefit A	17,955	5.1%
Health Care Card	16,280	4.6%
Disability Support Pension	14,330	4.0%
JobSeeker Payment	12,550	3.5% ▲
Carer Allowance	11,245	3.2%
Parenting Payment Single	5,965	1.7%
Youth Allowance (other)	1,515	0.4%

The most significant change this period is the 11.6% rise in JobSeeker recipients - from 11,240 to 12,550. This is broadly consistent with the LGA-level unemployment snapshot (April 2026 rate of 4.8%, above the NSW average) and reflects a deteriorating labour market position, particularly in Wyong. Commonwealth Rent Assistance recipients have also risen sharply to 27,695 - a signal that more low-income households are now in private rentals under financial stress.

DSP concentration: Wyong SA3 carries **57% of all DSP recipients** (8,170 vs 6,160) despite having 49% of the population:

Suburb	DSP Recipients	Population	DSP Rate
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	1,520	22,740	6.7%
Gosford - Springfield	1,150	22,599	5.1%
The Entrance	920	16,155	5.7%
Umina - Booker Bay - Patonga	980	25,007	3.9%
Bateau Bay - Killarney Vale	915	22,990	4.0%

The correlation between high DSP rates and high unemployment suggests entrenched health-related barriers to workforce participation in disadvantaged suburbs - a trend that is not improving.

4. Socioeconomic Disadvantage (SEIFA Analysis)

4.1 Most and Least Disadvantaged Suburbs

The SEIFA Index of Relative Socio-economic Disadvantage (IRSD) benchmarks at 1,000 nationally. Scores below 1,000 indicate relative disadvantage; scores above indicate relative advantage.

Most disadvantaged suburbs (SEIFA-D < 955 - significantly disadvantaged):

Suburb	SEIFA-D	Weekly Income	Unemployment	Year 12 (%)	Bachelor (%)
Wyong	897.3	\$1,056	8.1%	27.2%	5.5%
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	917.4	\$1,051	5.8%	24.3%	4.4%
Blue Haven - San Remo	920.1	\$1,250	5.8%	23.0%	3.3%
Toukley - Norah Head	938.6	\$971	5.4%	24.5%	5.5%
The Entrance	944.6	\$984	5.6%	29.1%	7.1%
Woy Woy - Blackwall	950.8	\$1,040	5.1%	32.3%	7.8%
Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park	951.7	\$977	4.2%	22.9%	4.7%
Budgewoi - Buff Point - Halekulani	953.6	\$1,005	4.7%	24.1%	4.8%

Least disadvantaged suburbs (SEIFA-D > 1,060 - relatively advantaged):

Suburb	SEIFA-D	Weekly Income	Unemployment	Year 12 (%)	Bachelor (%)
Wamberal - Forresters Beach	1,080.7	\$1,852	1.4%	41.2%	13.4%
Avoca Beach - Copacabana	1,079.3	\$1,869	1.1%	44.5%	14.7%
Terrigal - North Avoca	1,077.7	\$1,760	1.3%	45.5%	15.0%
Box Head - MacMasters Beach	1,064.0	\$1,412	1.3%	40.0%	11.9%
Jilliby - Yarramalong	1,060.2	\$1,942	3.2%	35.6%	9.7%

The income gap between most and least disadvantaged suburbs is \$971/wk (Toukley-Norah Head at \$971 vs Jilliby-Yarramalong at \$1,942). Residents in disadvantaged suburbs earn **less than half** of what residents in advantaged suburbs earn - a gap that compounds through housing costs, educational opportunity, and intergenerational mobility.

4.2 Spatial Clustering of Disadvantage

The eight most disadvantaged suburbs (SEIFA-D < 955) form a **continuous geographic corridor** through northern Wyong:

Wyong → Gorokan → Blue Haven → Toukley → The Entrance → Budgewoi → Lake Munmorah
↓
Woy Woy (Gosford outlier)

This spatial clustering reflects historical patterns of social housing allocation, distance from employment centres, lower land values attracting lower-income households, and self-reinforcing cycles of underinvestment. The rising JobSeeker and CRA figures confirm this corridor is not recovering - it is deepening in disadvantage relative to the broader LGA.

Policy implication: Dispersed, individual-focused interventions will be insufficient. Area-based place-making investment is required - targeting the entire corridor with coordinated employment, education, transport, and housing interventions.

5. Demographics & Population

5.1 Population Distribution

Five largest suburbs by population:

Suburb	Population	Region % of LGA
Umina - Booker Bay - Patonga	25,007	Gosford 7.0%
Bateau Bay - Killarney Vale	22,990	Wyong 6.5%
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	22,740	Wyong 6.4%
Gosford - Springfield	22,599	Gosford 6.4%
Warnervale - Wadalba	22,353	Wyong 6.3%

These five suburbs account for **32.6% of total LGA population** - a relatively dispersed settlement pattern without extreme population concentration.

5.2 Population Growth Dynamics

The LGA gained **2,903 residents** in 2023-24. Growth drivers vary significantly by suburb:

Suburb	Total Growth	Internal Migration	Overseas Migration	Growth Driver
Warnervale - Wadalba	+650	+469	+122	Internal migration
Gosford - Springfield	+516	+103	+305	Overseas migration
Terrigal - North Avoca	+207	-78	+224	Overseas migration
The Entrance	+187	+25	+138	Overseas migration
Summerland Point - Gwandalan	+161	+110	+21	Internal migration
Chittaway Bay - Tumbi Umbi	+131	+21	+93	Mixed

Warnervale - Wadalba absorbed **22% of all LGA population growth**, driven overwhelmingly by internal migration (+469) - households relocating from elsewhere in Australia (predominantly Sydney) seeking affordable family housing. **Gosford - Springfield** leads overseas migration (+305), reflecting its role as the regional centre with urban amenity, employment opportunities, and established migrant settlement services.

Declining suburbs: Toukley - Norah Head (-19), Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park (-27), and Kincumber - Picketts Valley (-8) recorded population losses - predominantly older coastal areas with ageing-in-place populations and limited new housing supply.

5.3 Age Profile

The Central Coast median age of **42.3 years** exceeds the national average (38.4 years). Age distribution varies dramatically by suburb:

Oldest suburbs (median age ≥ 47 years):

Suburb	Median Age	% Over 69	% Under 20	Age Pension Recipients
Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park	49	25.7%	19.5%	2,750
Erina - Green Point	49	26.0%	21.5%	2,835
Toukley - Norah Head	48	20.7%	20.7%	1,830
Box Head - MacMasters Beach	47	19.5%	22.0%	1,590
Kincumber - Picketts Valley	47	24.4%	22.9%	1,430
Woy Woy - Blackwall	47	19.9%	19.9%	2,590

Over **one quarter of residents** in Erina - Green Point (26.0%) and Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park (25.7%) are aged 69 or above. These suburbs will experience accelerating demand for aged care, healthcare, accessible housing, and transport services. Age Pension recipients now total **49,360** across the LGA (13.9% of population) - a number that will continue to rise as the resident cohort ages.

Youngest suburbs (median age ≤ 37 years):

Suburb	Median Age	% Under 20	% Over 69
Blue Haven - San Remo	34	29.2%	9.4%
Warnervale - Wadalba	35	31.5%	10.9%
Kariong	35	29.9%	6.6%
Tuggerah - Kangy Angy	37	27.1%	10.8%

Warnervale - Wadalba has the highest proportion of under-20s (31.5%) - consistent with its character as a growing family-oriented greenfield suburb requiring schools, childcare, and family services.

5.4 Education Attainment

Educational attainment strongly correlates with socioeconomic outcomes and follows the Gosford-Wyong divide:

Highest attainment suburbs:

Suburb	Bachelor Degree (%)	Year 12 (%)	Median Income/wk
Terrigal - North Avoca	15.0%	45.5%	\$1,760
Avoca Beach - Copacabana	14.7%	44.5%	\$1,869
Wamberal - Forresters Beach	13.4%	41.2%	\$1,852
Gosford - Springfield	12.3%	41.1%	\$1,197
Point Clare - Koolewong	12.0%	41.1%	\$1,407

Lowest attainment suburbs:

Suburb	Bachelor Degree (%)	Year 12 (%)	Median Income/wk
Blue Haven - San Remo	3.3%	23.0%	\$1,250
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	4.4%	24.3%	\$1,051
Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park	4.7%	22.9%	\$977
Summerland Point - Gwandalan	4.8%	24.9%	\$1,186
Budgewoi - Buff Point - Halekulani	4.8%	24.1%	\$1,005

The gap between highest and lowest suburbs is **11.7 percentage points** for bachelor degrees (15.0% vs 3.3%) and **22.6 percentage points** for Year 12 completion (45.5% vs 22.9%). This education divide is self-reinforcing without targeted intervention in northern Wyong schools and vocational pathways.

5.5 Cultural Diversity & Indigenous Population

The LGA is predominantly English-speaking, with cultural diversity concentrated in specific suburbs:

Highest cultural diversity:

Suburb	% Born Overseas	% LOTE	Key Observation
Gosford - Springfield	21.2%	13.2%	Regional centre attracting migrants
Erina - Green Point	19.6%	6.9%	Commercial/retail employment hub
Terrigal - North Avoca	19.2%	6.4%	Coastal amenity attracting international buyers
Blue Haven - San Remo	18.8%	6.4%	Sydney commuter

Point Clare - Koolewong	19.2%	8.1%	suburb
Tuggerah - Kangy Angy	18.5%	10.4%	Industrial/logistics employment

Indigenous population concentration:

Suburb	% Indigenous	Total Indigenous	SEIFA-D
Blue Haven - San Remo	7.8%	859	920.1
Wyong	6.6%	583	897.3
Budgewoi - Buff Point - Halekulani	6.0%	561	953.6
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	5.6%	1,247	917.4
Toukley - Norah Head	4.9%	482	938.6

The five suburbs with the highest Indigenous population share are **all in the most disadvantaged quintile** (SEIFA-D < 955). **Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven** has the largest absolute Indigenous population (1,247) and should be prioritised for Indigenous-specific service delivery. The spatial overlap between Indigenous concentration and socioeconomic disadvantage reinforces the urgency of Closing the Gap investment in the northern Wyong corridor.

6. Tourism & Short-Stay Economy

6.1 Airbnb Performance

Short-stay accommodation activity has expanded significantly, with total Airbnb gross revenue reaching **\$3.91M** across 1,692 active listings - up from \$2.78M and 1,637 listings in the prior period.

Suburb	Gross Revenue	Occupancy (%)	ADR (\$)	Active Listings
Avoca Beach - Copacabana	\$675,611	18.5%	\$510	347
Terrigal - North Avoca	\$661,707	22.5%	\$494	268
Umina - Booker Bay - Patonga	\$621,698	23.3%	\$391	301
Box Head - MacMasters Beach	\$591,908	18.8%	\$616	202
The Entrance	\$583,473	26.8%	\$381	296
Wamberal - Forresters Beach	\$336,195	22.0%	\$537	121
Toukley - Norah Head	\$191,867	26.0%	\$336	65
Bateau Bay - Killarney Vale	\$119,564	43.0%	\$245	50
Woy Woy - Blackwall	\$107,640	33.0%	\$402	31
Kincumber - Picketts Valley	\$20,661	20.0%	\$517	10

Key patterns: - **Box Head - MacMasters Beach** now commands the highest ADR (\$616), displacing Wamberal as the top-yield short-stay destination - consistent with its position as the top house rent suburb (\$1,086/wk) - **Avoca Beach - Copacabana** generates highest total revenue (\$675k) through volume (347 listings) - a 27% increase on the prior period - **Bateau Bay - Killarney Vale** achieves the highest occupancy (43%) at a budget ADR (\$245) - serving a high-volume, lower-yield family/group segment - **The Entrance** has grown strongly (296 listings, 26.8% occupancy) - positioned as a mid-tier coastal destination competing on accessibility and price

The 41% revenue increase across the portfolio signals that short-stay accommodation is actively competing with long-term rental stock in coastal suburbs, contributing to reduced rental availability and upward pressure on rents.

6.2 Visitor vs Resident Economic Activity

Category	Total Value	% of Total
Visitor Spend	\$69,076,000	16.8%
Resident Spend	\$341,471,000	83.2%
Total Economic Activity	\$410,547,000	100%

Top visitor spend suburbs:

Suburb	Visitor Spend	Resident Spend	Visitor Share
Umina - Booker Bay - Patonga	\$3,973,000	\$17,945,000	18.1%
The Entrance	\$4,029,000	\$10,856,000	27.1%
Terrigal - North Avoca	\$3,385,000	\$6,659,000	33.7%
Wyong	\$3,995,000	\$9,216,000	30.2%
Gosford - Springfield	\$6,741,000	\$42,476,000	13.7%

Terrigal - North Avoca has the highest visitor share of any suburb with substantial activity (33.7%) - consistent with its premium coastal hospitality positioning. **Jilliby - Yarramalong** continues to generate visitor spend (\$2,884,000) that substantially exceeds its resident spend (\$631,000) - a visitor-to-resident ratio of **4.6:1**, reflecting its character as a rural tourism/events destination.

Policy implication: While tourism contributes meaningfully, the regional economy is fundamentally driven by its permanent resident base (83% of tracked activity). Employment support, income growth, and local business development for residents should take precedence over tourism promotion in economic development strategy.

7. Homelessness & Housing Vulnerability

7.1 Homelessness Distribution

Total homelessness count across the LGA: **1,740 persons**

Region	Homelessness Count	Population	Rate per 1,000
Wyong SA3	1,170	173,145	6.8
Gosford SA3	570	181,658	3.1
LGA Total	1,740	354,803	4.9

Wyong records **more than double** the homelessness rate of Gosford (6.8 vs 3.1 per 1,000 population).

Highest homelessness suburbs:

Suburb	Homeless Count	Population	Rate per 1,000
The Entrance	273	16,155	16.9
Wyong	236	9,360	25.2
Gosford - Springfield	160	22,599	7.1
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	138	22,740	6.1
Toukley - Norah Head	134	9,847	13.6

Wyong records the highest homelessness rate in the LGA at **25.2 per 1,000** - five times the LGA average and eight times the Gosford SA3 average. Combined with 8.1% unemployment, the lowest SEIFA score in the region, and high JobSeeker dependency, Wyong requires intensive wraparound service delivery.

7.2 Rent Assistance as Housing Stress Indicator

Commonwealth Rent Assistance recipients have risen to **27,695** - up 16% from the prior period's 23,785. This is the most alarming single indicator in the April 2026 dataset. CRA is only available to recipients of certain income support payments who pay rent above a threshold; a 16% rise suggests a significant expansion of private rental stress, particularly in Wyong where:

Suburb	CRA Recipients	Population	CRA Rate (%)
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	2,565	22,740	11.3%
The Entrance	2,030	16,155	12.6%
Umina - Booker Bay - Patonga	2,425	25,007	9.7%
Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park	1,890	11,055	17.1%

Wyong	1,180	9,360	12.6%
Bateau Bay - Killarney Vale	1,465	22,990	6.4%

Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park at 17.1% CRA rate is particularly concerning - nearly one in five residents is receiving rent assistance, reflecting a combination of low incomes, high welfare dependency (49-year median age, 25.7% aged 69+), and a tight local rental market.

8. Crime & Community Safety

Source: BOCSAR NSW Crime Statistics | **Period:** January-December 2025 | **Metric:** Rate per 1,000 population

8.1 LGA-Wide Crime Profile

Crime rates across the Central Coast LGA reflect and reinforce the Gosford-Wyong socioeconomic divide. Wyong SA3 records substantially higher offence rates across all five categories measured.

Offence Category	Gosford SA3	Wyong SA3	LGA Average
Assault	3.33	4.55	3.87
Theft	14.39	23.71	18.54
Intimidation, Stalking & Harassment	4.92	8.49	6.51
Malicious Damage to Property	4.55	6.61	5.46
Drug Offences	2.35	3.87	3.05

Rates per 1,000 population. Data coverage: 27 of 30 CC SA2s.

Wyong SA3 records **37% higher assault rates**, **65% higher theft rates**, and **73% higher intimidation rates** than Gosford SA3 - mirroring the same spatial pattern seen in unemployment, SEIFA disadvantage, and welfare dependency.

8.2 High-Crime Hotspots

Suburb	Assault	Theft	ISH	MDP	Drug	SEIFA-D	Unemp
Wyong	12.36	42.12	23.19	19.58	16.41	897	8.1%
Gosford - Springfield	9.76	39.66	10.89	11.69	12.87	983	3.6%
Tuggerah - Kangy Angy	9.38	83.09	6.89	6.51	6.32	1,013	2.6%
Woy Woy - Blackwall	6.00	19.66	8.44	9.27	4.60	951	5.1%
Gorokan - Kanwal - Charmhaven	5.82	20.91	12.00	8.37	3.54	917	5.8%

Rates per 1,000 population.

Wyong leads all five offence categories by a significant margin. Its assault rate of 12.36 is **3.2x the LGA average**, and its intimidation rate of 23.19 is **3.6x the LGA average**. Combined with 8.1% unemployment, SEIFA score of 897, and the highest homelessness rate in the LGA (25.2 per 1,000), Wyong represents the most acute concentration of compounding disadvantage in the region.

Tuggerah - Kangy Angy presents a distinct pattern: an extreme theft rate (83.09 - the highest in the LGA by a wide margin) against a moderate SEIFA score (1,013) and low unemployment (2.6%). This is characteristic of **retail/commercial-area opportunity theft** rather than disadvantage-driven crime - Tuggerah's major retail precinct (Westfield Tuggerah) drives concentrated retail theft. A different policy problem to the disadvantage-driven crime in Wyong.

Gosford - Springfield, as the regional commercial centre, shows elevated rates across all categories - particularly drug offences (12.87) and theft (39.66) - consistent with its role as the regional hub attracting both economic activity and transient populations.

8.3 Youth Offending Context

BOCSAR's LGA-level reporting identifies the top offence sub-types committed by young people on the Central Coast:

1. Non-domestic violence assault
2. Intimidation, Stalking & Harassment
3. Driving offences
4. Steal from retail store
5. Disorderly conduct
6. Drug offences
7. Break & enter dwelling
8. Malicious damage to property

The prominence of **Intimidation, Stalking & Harassment at #2** is regionally anomalous - nationally this category skews older. The spatial concentration of ISH in the Wyong corridor (Wyong: 23.19, Gorokan: 12.00, Toukley-Norah Head: 11.30) suggests a youth cohort dynamic that warrants attention. Suburbs with the highest ISH rates overlap with those showing highest youth population shares and lowest Year 12 completion rates.

The data supports targeted **youth crime prevention investment** in the Wyong-Gorokan-Toukley corridor, focused on early intervention, educational re-engagement, and diversion programs.

8.4 Low-Crime Suburbs

Suburb	Assault	Theft	ISH	SEIFA-D
Lake Munmorah - Mannering Park	0.09	1.28	n/a	952
Saratoga - Davistown	0.42	n/a	n/a	1,056
Box Head - MacMasters Beach	0.63	4.98	1.27	1,064
Wamberal - Forresters Beach	0.94	11.43	n/a	1,081
Avoca Beach - Copacabana	1.06	14.74	2.66	1,079

The contrast between Lake Munmorah (assault: 0.09) and Wyong (assault: 12.36) - both within the same LGA - represents a **137x difference in assault rate**. This magnitude of within-LGA variation reinforces the case for place-based, suburb-level responses rather than LGA-wide averages.

9. Key Findings & Priorities for April 2026

What Has Changed Since Prior Period

Indicator	Prior	Current	Trend
LGA avg house price	\$1,168,505	\$1,191,900	↑ Rising
Price-to-income ratio	16.4×	16.7×	↑ Worsening
JobSeeker recipients	~11,240	12,550	↑ +11.6%
Commonwealth Rent Assistance	~23,785	27,695	↑ +16.4%
Erina - Green Point house price	\$2,087,500	\$1,974,000	↓ Softening
Premium tier prices generally	-	Moderating	↓
Airbnb gross revenue	\$2.78M	\$3.91M	↑ +41%
Warnervale approvals	222	204	↓ Easing
LGA avg weekly rent	\$709	\$729	↑ Rising

Priority Issues

- 1. Income support crisis in northern Wyong** The 11.6% increase in JobSeeker and 16.4% increase in CRA are the most urgent signals in this dataset. The five suburbs forming the northern disadvantage corridor - Wyong, Gorokan, Blue Haven, Toukley, The Entrance - require targeted employment programs, not general economic stimulus. Structural unemployment in these suburbs does not respond to region-wide job creation.
- 2. Housing affordability at a breaking point** A price-to-income ratio of 16.7× is unsustainable. The easing in Gosford’s premium tier (\$1.97M → down from \$2.09M at Erina) has not translated to affordability improvement; entry-level Wyong prices have continued rising. Without accelerated social and affordable housing supply, rental stress will deepen further.
- 3. Short-stay accommodation is displacing renters** The 41% increase in Airbnb revenue signals an accelerating shift of coastal housing stock to short-stay use. Without proactive regulation, this

will continue to reduce rental availability and push vulnerable households further into housing stress.

4. Aged care demand is building 49,360 Age Pension recipients - 13.9% of the LGA - with suburban concentrations exceeding 25% aged 69+ in Erina-Green Point and Lake Munmorah. Infrastructure planning must anticipate step-change increases in healthcare, transport, and in-home support requirements.

5. Warnervale-Wadalba infrastructure deficit With 22% of LGA population growth and 204 dwelling approvals – still the highest in the LGA – this suburb’s infrastructure (schools, childcare, transport, health) continues to lag supply. The youngest median age (35) and highest under-20 share (31.5%) mean demand for education and family services will intensify for the next decade.

6. Crime concentration mirrors disadvantage - and demands a youth response The BOCSAR data confirms what the socioeconomic indicators predict: crime is heavily concentrated in the northern Wyong disadvantage corridor, with Wyong suburb recording 3.2x the LGA average assault rate and 3.6x the average intimidation rate. The anomalous prevalence of Intimidation, Stalking & Harassment as the #2 youth offence on the Central Coast – a pattern not seen at the national level – signals an emerging youth cohort issue specific to this region. Combined with the lowest Year 12 completion rates and highest youth unemployment in the LGA, a targeted diversion and early intervention program for the Wyong-Gorokan-Toukley corridor is warranted. Separately, Tuggerah - Kangy Angy’s extreme retail theft rate (83 per 1,000) is a commercial precinct management issue distinct from the disadvantage-driven crime in Wyong, and requires different intervention.

Report generated from April/May 2026 indicator data (June 2026 refresh). Crime data from BOCSAR NSW, January-December 2025, rates per 1,000 population. SA2-level data sourced from ABS, CoreLogic, Airdna, Services Australia, and BOCSAR. All dollar values in AUD. Population data based on 2021 Census with 2023-24 ERP update.